

enemy ships which are carrying armies or occupying strategic positions. Named during a game in which one of the players repeatedly used the tactic while playing Orion ship G, showing up in the player list as ‘Og’.” So basically, the term Og, or Ogg, means to force an action, without worrying much about the future or the losses suffered.

What does Ogg have to do with audio compression? Well, quite simply, the encoding process was so taxing on the computers of those days that if you started *Ogging* a song, you could pretty much forget about doing anything else, because the processor was too bogged down.

Vorbis is Xiph’s “audio compression scheme” (read: algorithm), which is contained in an Ogg container. If the word “container” confuses you, think of it as a box in which packaged goods are sent. So, the Ogg container can contain audio in the FLAC or the Speex formats, apart from Vorbis, obviously.

Ogg Vorbis is generally considered a much better compression format than MP3, and is comparable (if not better in some cases) to WMA or AAC. Files compressed using Vorbis are smaller than their MP3 counterparts of comparable audio quality, which translates to better distribution in the streaming form over the Net. Also, because it is completely open source and free, artists who use this format to sell music never have to pay any royalties to anyone for using the format. For example, if you sell music in the MP3 format, you have to pay a small percentage of your earnings to Fraunhofer, who own the patents to much of the technology underlying that format.

Also, for those with large collections of 192 or 320 Kbps MP3s, a huge disk space saving lies in store if you convert all your files to 128 Kbps Ogg Vorbis files. Everyone claims better quality of sound for 128 Kbps Oggs than 192 Kbps MP3s!